



Confederate navy frock coat

This typical Confederate officer's frock coat belonged to Lieutenant William F. Robinson of the Confederate States Navy, who served on various ships in the waters around New Orleans and Mobile.

The sinking of the Alabama

"My intention is to fight the *Kearsarge* as soon as I can make the necessary arrangements," Semmes wrote to a U.S. diplomat through an intermediary. "I beg she will not depart until I am ready to go out." On June 19, dressed in his finest uniform, Semmes sailed the *Alabama* out into the English Channel, where the *Kearsarge* was waiting just beyond the 3-mile (4.8-km) territorial limit. Thousands thronged the Normandy cliffs to watch the duel, which lasted little more than an hour. Maneuvering slowly around each other, the combatants were soon engulfed in smoke. The *Alabama* fired 370